Pattern Headings: Literary Works entered under Title

H 1155.8

Pattern: *Beowulf*

A. Recent revisions 1
B. Types of headings covered by the pattern 1
C. Types of headings not covered by the pattern 1
D. Conflicts 2
E. LC practice ..... **Error! Bookmark not defined.**
F. Special provisions 2
G. List of topical subdivisions 2
H. List of form subdivisions 4
Revision history 5

A. Recent revisions

2026-01: Updated template. Clarified text. Separated general and form subdivisions. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

B. Types of headings covered by the pattern

Headings for literary works entered directly under uniform title.

Examples:

Arabian nights

Chanson de Roland

Charlemagne (Play)

Guillaume (Chanson de geste)

C. Types of headings not covered by the pattern

The subject cataloging of anonymous sacred classics, for example, ***Bible***; ***Qur'an***; ***Vedas***, differs substantially and should not be confused with the treatment of the literary works

discussed here. For free-floating subdivisions used under the uniform titles of sacred works, see H 1188. For subdivisions used under literary works entered under author, see H 1155.6.

D. Conflicts

Any subdivision listed here can be used as a free-floating subdivision under any heading belonging to the category if it is appropriate and no conflict exists in the subject authority file. Subject authority records may exist for headings employing variant phrases or subdivisions equivalent to subdivisions on this list.

LC practice: If an exceptional variant form is to be retained, make a UF reference from the equivalent free-floating subdivision form following the procedures in H 195 if the reference does not yet exist. Otherwise, submit a proposal to change the variant form along with all bibliographic records requiring correction following the procedures in H 193.

E. Special provisions

The subdivisions listed in H 1095 as authorized for use under subjects in general, for example, ***--Bibliography*** or ***--Exhibitions***, or under individual works (author-title or title entries), for example, ***--Concordances*** or ***--Sources***, are also free-floating under literary works. The additional subdivisions listed below follow the usage given in the individual literary authors list (H 1110). Do not use the subdivision ***--Criticism and interpretation*** under entries for literary works. For a work of *general criticism and interpretation* or a discussion combining the approaches of several subdivisions, assign as a subject heading the uniform title of the literary work *without* subdivision.

F. List of topical subdivisions

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
***$x* Adaptations**		Use under literary works entered under title for works about adaptations of those works.
***$x* Appreciation**	Yes	
***$x* Authorship**		
***$x* Characters**		Use under literary works entered under title for works about the work's characters in general, a specific group or category of characters, or specific named characters.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
***$x* Criticism, Textual**		
***$x* Dramatic production**		Use literary works entered under the title for works on various aspects of stage presentation, e.g. acting, costume, stage setting, and scenery, etc.
***$x* Film adaptations**		
Film and video adaptations	--	*See "Film adaptations" and "Television adaptations"*
***$x* Illustrations**		Use under individual literary works entered under title for works about pictorial representation of those works.
***$x* Language**		
***$x* Manuscripts**		Use under individual works entered under title for works about manuscripts of those titles.
***$x* Parodies, imitations, etc.**		Use under individual literary works entered under title for works about imitations, either comic or distorted, of those titles.
***$x* Style**		
***$x* Television adaptations**		
***$x* Translations**		Use under individual literary works entered under title for works about translations.
***$x* Translations *$x* History and criticism**		
***$x* Translations into French, [German, etc.] *$x* History and criticism**		

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
***$x* Versification**		Use under literary works entered under title for works on the author's technique of writing verse.

G. List of form subdivisions

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, Library of Congress catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT) to bring out the form(s) and/or genre(s) of the resource being cataloged. The form subdivisions maintained on this list are not available for use by LC catalogers. Catalogers at institutions external to LC may use them as dictated by their own institutional policies.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
***$v* Adaptations**		Use under literary works entered under title and individual literatures for collections of adaptations of those works.
***$v* Film adaptations**		Use under individual literary works entered under title for collections of film adaptations of those works.
Film and video adaptations	--	*See "Film adaptations" and "Television adaptations"*
***$v* Illustrations**		Use under individual literary works entered under title for collections of pictorial representations of those works.
***$x* Language *$v* Glossaries, etc.**		
***$v* Manuscripts *$v* Facsimiles**		Use under literary works entered under title for facsimile editions of manuscripts of those works.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$v **Parodies, imitations, etc.**		Use under individual literary works entered under title for imitations, either comic or distorted, of those titles.
$v **Television adaptations**		Use under individual literary works entered under title for collections of television adaptations of those works.
$v **Translations**		Do not use for single translations. Use under individual literary works entered under title for collections of translated works.

Revision history

2026-01: Updated template. Clarified text. Separated general and form subdivisions. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.